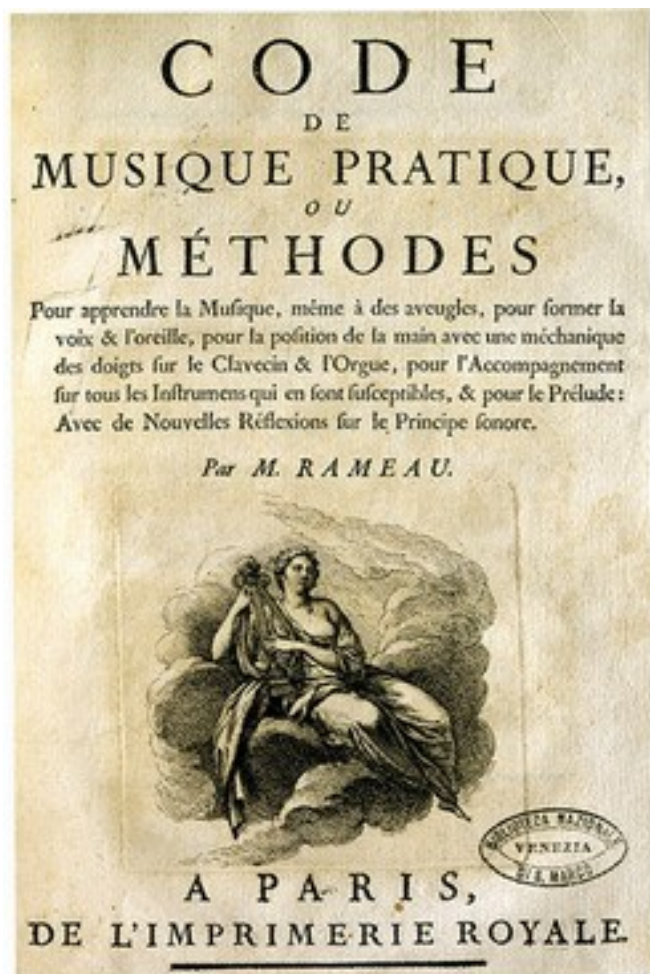


concentrating mainly on sacred music, but a major breakthrough still eluded him. In part, this may have been due to Rameau's prickly temperament (the writer Voltaire was among those with whom he had a tempestuous relationship). Eventually, he found a patron in the financier Le Riche de la Pouplinière, who enabled him to stage his opera *Hippolyte et Aricie* in 1733. (The work later divided the critics: devotees of the operatic composer Jean-Baptiste Lully found it too brash, too "Italian," but it also won many admirers.)



TITLE PAGE, *CODE OF MUSIC PRACTICE*
Rameau's Code of Music Practice, published in 1760,